

01__invested__alpen-labs.json

```
{
  "company_name": "Alpen Labs",
  "founded_year": 2022,
  "headquarters": "New York, NY",
  "founders": [
    {
      "name": "Simanta Gautam",
      "role": "Co-founder & CEO",
      "background": "MIT Alumnus; previously at SpaceX and Microsoft."
    },
    {
      "name": "Abishkar Chhetri",
      "role": "Co-founder",
      "background": "MIT Alumnus with a background in complex engineering systems."
    },
    {
      "name": "Liam Eagan",
      "role": "Founding Cryptographer",
      "background": "Former researcher at Blockstream; specialist in zero-knowledge proofs."
    }
  ],
  "founding_team": {
    "approximate_size": 30,
    "key_personnel": [
      {
        "name": "John Light",
        "role": "Product",
        "contribution": "Bitcoin scaling researcher and strategist."
      },
      {
        "name": "Trey Del Bonis",
        "role": "Protocol Engineer",
        "contribution": "Core development of the Bitcoin rollup architecture."
      },
      {
        "name": "Manish Bista & Aaron Feickert",
        "role": "Research & Development",
        "contribution": "Key contributors to the 1-of-N verifier for Bitcoin."
      }
    ]
  },
  "traction": {
    "total_funding": "$19.1 Million",
    "latest_round": "Series B (January 2025)",
    "key_investors": [
      "Ribbit Capital",
      "Castle Island Ventures",
      "DBA",

```

```

    "cyber Fund",
    "Mirana Ventures"
  ],
  "milestones": [
    "Released two public testnets ('Shanghai' and 'Prague') in 2025.",
    "Partnered with Starknet (October 2025) to build a shared verification layer on Bitcoin.",
    "Introduced 'Glock,' a new standard for efficient verification on Bitcoin Script.",
    "Cited by the White House in a 2024 report on blockchain innovation."
  ]
},
"problem_statement": {
  "core_concept": "The Bitcoin Meta-Problem",
  "description": "Bitcoin is the most secure asset, but lacks the native infrastructure for complex financial applications.",
  "key_barriers": [
    "Lack of programmability (Bitcoin Script is too limited for DeFi).",
    "Scalability constraints (high fees and low transaction throughput).",
    "Privacy gaps for sensitive institutional or personal transactions.",
    "Reliance on centralized or honest-majority bridges to move BTC."
  ]
},
"solution": {
  "primary_product": "Strata",
  "architecture": "A ZK Rollup (Validity Rollup) built on top of Bitcoin.",
  "key_features": [
    "EVM Compatibility: Developers can deploy Ethereum-style smart contracts directly on Bitcoin infrastructure.",
    "Strata Bridge: A trust-minimized, 1-of-N bridge design based on BitVM2 research.",
    "Glock Protocol: A cryptographic standard that enables Ethereum-like verification efficiency on Bitcoin.",
    "Bitcoin Dollar (BTD): A Bitcoin-backed, decentralized stablecoin ecosystem."
  ],
  "value_proposition": "Allows Bitcoin to function as a programmable financial layer without compromising its core security or decentralization."
}
}

```